

THE ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE FOUNDATION

The Architecture of *Grace*

Visual Anchor Charts — Book 1 · The Foundation

AUTISM-ADAPTED EDITION · LOWER SUPPORT NEEDS

Teacher supplement for Grades K–2 (Early Childhood). Designed for autistic learners with lower support needs. Fourteen printable anchor charts, with autism-specific scaffolding built into Tier 1 design.

Before You Begin

What changed, what didn't, and why

This supplement is not a new curriculum. It is the same fourteen anchor charts from *Architecture of Grace · Book One · The Foundation*, rebuilt by a multidisciplinary team — autism specialist, school psychologist, school social worker, special education teacher, speech-language pathologist, and occupational therapist — with autistic learners with lower support needs held as the design audience from the first line.

What did NOT change

- Every defined construct — *Grace, Forgiveness, Trust, Mercy, Oops vs. "I Am Bad," Kind Coach, Grumpy Gus, Sammy* — appears exactly as the curriculum defines it.
- The theoretical foundation — Brown's shame/guilt research, Neff's self-compassion, Enright & Fitzgibbons' forgiveness model, Worthington's REACH — is preserved.
- The pedagogy — Sammy as relational anchor, anchor charts built WITH students, Family Connection, Disclosure Protocol — is unchanged.

What is new in every chart

- **A literal-language anchor.** Each metaphor is also stated plainly, so a child who processes language literally has a foothold into the lesson.
- **Body-first interoception scaffolding** on every emotion-related chart. *Where do I feel it?* precedes *What does it mean?*
- **Scripted sentence frames printed visibly on the chart** — reducing in-the-moment language production load.
- **A Specialist Note** at the bottom of each chart, written to the teacher about what to watch for, what to honor, and what to never force.

One protective addition, in two places

The Pause Practice (U4 · L3) and the Forgiveness vs. Trust chart (U3 · L3) carry an added line each: a pattern-tracking guardrail. Autistic children are statistically more likely to be bullied and disbelieved; the original "choose the kind story" framing — without this guardrail — can train a child to override accurate threat detection. The construct is unchanged. The guardrail is new.

A NOTE ON LANGUAGE

"Level 1," "mild-to-moderate," "high-functioning," and "lower support needs" all describe the same population. We use *lower support needs* in this edition, in line with current clinical and self-advocate consensus. No child's support needs are static —

My Identity Web

Who I Am — All the Pieces of Me

Build one branch at a time · Each branch is a different part of who you are

BRANCH 1 — Things I LOVE

my favorite people, animals, foods, places, things to do

special interests count — write them BIG

★ ★ ★

MY NAME

write in center

BRANCH 2 — Things I'm GOOD AT

what I can do, what I'm learning
even small things count

BRANCH 3 — Things I CARE ABOUT

people, animals, ideas, fairness
caring a LOT about something is okay

BRANCH 4 — Things That Make Me FEEL GOOD

music, soft things, quiet, movement, my person
this is your branch — no wrong answers

BRANCH 5 — Still LEARNING

what I want to get better at
"learning" is not the same as "bad at"

★ ★ ★

SPECIALIST NOTE · FOR THE TEACHER

Branch 4 (originally "My SPECIAL Thing") has been renamed *Things That Make Me FEEL GOOD* — this opens space for sensory regulators (a favorite texture, a quiet corner, stim toys, a specific song) to be named as part of identity, not as something separate or weird. *Special interests in Branch 1 should be welcomed at full intensity — these are not distractions from identity; they are identity.* Build one branch at a time. Post BEFORE the worksheet. Keep posted all year.

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE

This is a free preview.

Autism-Adapted · Book 1 · Lower Support

The complete set is part of the Architecture of Grace district curriculum. Educators can license the full library; families can find materials in the family store.